

F-15E STRIKE EAGLE • COCKPIT MFD OVERLAY



MODERN F-15E

SITUATIONAL AWARENESS OVERLAY

MODERN F-15E • USER MANUAL
WINDOWS TRAY APP • COCKPIT OVERLAY

VERSION 1.60.2

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MOD	PLATFORM	VERSION
Modern F-15E	Windows 10/11	1.60.2

VIDEO TUTORIAL

Prefer to watch rather than read? **Squirrel** has put together a full walkthrough of setting up and flying the SIT:

youtube.com/watch?v=hRTC94cPPys

With thanks to Squirrel for creating it.

01 Requirements

SYSTEM & GAME REQUIREMENTS

REQUIREMENT	DETAIL
Operating system	Windows 10 or Windows 11 (64-bit).
DCS World	A current DCS World install (standalone or Steam). The app auto-detects common install and Saved Games locations.
Aircraft module	The F-15E Strike Eagle module. The SIT page appears on the F-15E cockpit MFD.
Internet	Only for automatic updates — the app checks for and downloads new releases in the background (§14). It runs fully offline otherwise.
Input device	Optional but recommended: a HOTAS with a slew axis (e.g. a throttle TDC slew) to drive the SIT cursor in manual mode.

TIP • CLOSE DCS WHILE SETTING UP

The overlay file is locked while DCS is running. Do your install and first-time setup with **DCS closed**, then launch DCS. The app will tell you if it needs DCS closed to finish a file update.

02 Installing

Installation is a single setup program, followed by a one-time setup: accept the terms, then point the app at your DCS folders.

01 Download the installer

Get the latest setup package from the official GitHub releases page and run it. The installer sets the app up for you; no manual file copying is needed.

02 Launch the app

On first launch a single instance starts and sits in your **system tray** (the icons next to the clock). If it is already running, launching again just reminds you to check the tray.

03 Accept the Terms of Use

The very first time it runs, a short **Terms of Use** screen appears. Read it, tick *"I have read and agree,"* and click to continue (closes the app). You only see this once.

04 Confirm the DCS script install

The app installs a small script into your DCS **Saved Games** folder to read live game data. If exactly one DCS folder is found it is done silently; otherwise you confirm which folder to use.

05 Confirm your DCS install folder

Because the SA page is on by default, the app then asks you to confirm your DCS **game (install) folder** — the one containing , not Saved Games. See §3.

03 First-Time Setup

Everything is driven from the tray icon's right-click menu. Right-click the Modern F-15E tray icon to open it.

The tray menu contains:

- **SA Page Enabled** — the master switch that installs/removes the SIT page in DCS (checked when on).
- **DCS files: ...** — a status line (greyed, not clickable) reporting whether the deployed DCS-side files match the app.
- **Verify files** — checks the deployed DCS files and, if any are out of date, offers to repair them.
- **Controls...** — binds your cursor slew, HMD-centre calibrate, screenshot and other controls (§13).
- **Start with Windows** — launch on sign-in (§14).
- **Enable Diagnostics** — extra logging (on by default).
- **HMD on Bottom Monitor** — for a vertical two-monitor setup, tells the app the 3D view is on the bottom screen (§10).
- **Use Visor for HMD** — the helmet shows only with the visor down; on by default (§10).
- **VR Enabled** — registers the OpenXR layer for the crisp VR HMD (§10).
- **HMD VR...** — tunes the VR helmet view: size, text size, line strength (§10).
- **Settings...** — opens the settings file (§14).
- **User Guide** — opens this document.
- Updates install themselves automatically (§14); an optional **Restart to Update** row appears only if you want to apply one immediately rather than on next launch.
- Version / **Exit** rows.

► Point the app at your DCS install

If your DCS folder wasn't auto-detected, the **Cockpit Overlay** dialog asks you to confirm it. Pick the detected path, or **Browse...** to the folder that contains **bin\DCS.exe** (your install directory — *not* Saved Games), then click **Confirm**. The dialog refuses a folder that doesn't contain **bin\DCS.exe**.

► Enable the SA page

The **SA Page Enabled** toggle is the master switch. It is **on by default** and auto-enables on first run. Turning it **on** makes the SIT page available in the F-15E cockpit; turning it **off** removes it and returns your cockpit to stock. DCS must be **closed** to enable or disable it.

► The "DCS files" status & Verify

The greyed **DCS files: ...** line tells you, at a glance, whether the app's DCS-side files are current. It refreshes when you open the menu:

"DCS FILES" STATUS LINE

YOU SEE	MEANING
DCS files: up to date	All deployed files match this app build. Nothing to do.
DCS files: needs repair	A file is missing or out of date (an app update, or a DCS patch reverted it). Click Verify files .
DCS files: update pending – close DCS	A file needs updating but DCS is running and has it locked. Close DCS, then run Verify files (or relaunch the app).
DCS files: not configured	The DCS folders aren't known yet — finish setup / enable the SA page.

Verify files checks each deployed file and reports its state. If everything is current it says *"All DCS files are up to date."* If a file is out of date it offers to repair — restoring your stock DCS files and redeploying. If DCS is open, close it and run **Verify files** again.

04 Using It In-Cockpit

With the SA page enabled and DCS running in the F-15E, the SIT page is available on the MFDs just like any other format.

► Bringing up the SIT page

The SIT page lives on the **TSD** (Tactical Situation Display) — **not** the ENG page (ENG now shows the normal engine page again). To bring it up:

1. Select **TSD** on whichever MFD you want to use. A small green **SIT** softkey box appears on the TSD page (at OSB10).
2. Make that TSD the **Sensor Of Interest (SOI)** — throw the **Castle switch** toward that display. When the TSD is SOI, the SIT page appears.

Move the Castle away (another sensor becomes SOI) and the display returns to the normal TSD. You can do this on more than one MFD and the SA appears on each. The page is heading-up and centered on your jet (cyan aircraft symbol).

POWER REQUIRED

Your jet must be powered up with the **engines running** so the MFDs are live. Cold-and-dark with the displays off, there is no page for the overlay to detect and the SIT won't appear.

► JTIDS must be on **NEW**

The datalink half of the picture is gated on the jet's own **JTIDS** switch, exactly as it is in the real aircraft. Set it to **NORM** and the SIT shows datalink tracks — aircraft, your flight, ships and donors. Leave it off and those tracks are hidden.



The **JTIDS** switch — turn it to **NORM** to bring the datalink picture up on the SIT.

Data from your **data cartridge** is not affected: SAM and EWR threat rings and your flight-plan waypoints keep showing with JTIDS off, because none of that arrives over the datalink. So a SIT with JTIDS off still gives you the threat picture and your route — just no live tracks.

IF THE SCOPE LOOKS EMPTY

Contacts missing but waypoints and SAM rings present is the classic sign that **JTIDS is off**. Check the switch before anything else.

05 Contacts & Symbols

▸ Reading contacts & symbols

Contact symbols encode identity by shape and colour. Aircraft take an **IFF shape** — friendly a circle, bandit a triangle, unknown a square — and ships a trapezoid. There is **no type text**: the **altitude** (in thousands of feet) sits just above the symbol, and a short **heading stalk** points the way it's flying.



FRIENDLY – green circle

A friendly aircraft.



BANDIT – red triangle

NEW A hostile aircraft. The nose points where it's going.



UNKNOWN – yellow square

NEW Not identified as friend or foe.



SHIP – trapezoid

NEW A naval contact. Blue friendly, red hostile.



SAM / EWR – yellow label + ring

A label (e.g. **10** = SA-10, **S** = EWR) with a yellow threat ring at its lethal range. Only enemy air-defense is drawn — friendly SAM/EWR are left off the page.



DONOR-ONLY – dotted outline

NEW Seen through a datalink donor (AWACS / EWR), not your own radar. Same shape and colour, dotted outline. Goes solid once your radar paints it.



DONOR – filled dot beneath

A small filled dot just under a symbol marks a donor — a friendly AWACS or ground EWR radar feeding the datalink picture. Example: a friendly AWACS is a green circle with a dot below it. (See [Datalink, donors & the flight picture.](#))



FLIGHT MEMBER – cyan circle + number

A member of your own flight: a cyan circle with its flight number (**1–4**) inside, in place of a type. Your flight is numbered for you — see [Your Flight](#).

A small line extending from an air symbol is its **velocity/heading vector**. The number **above** the symbol is its **altitude** in thousands of feet — the only per-contact readout, as on the real jet. **Own jet**: a cyan aircraft symbol low on the scope. The page is heading-up, so the picture expands forward.

06 Your Flight & the JTIDS Page

Your flight — the other F-15Es slotted with you — is tracked as a live roster and drawn in **cyan** on both the SIT and the HMD. Each member wears its **flight number** (**1–4**) inside a cyan circle in place of a type, so you can pick your wingmen out of the picture at a glance. Cyan flight members are **always shown** and are never decluttered — a flightmate's position comes over the datalink, not from your radar, so you keep him even with your own radar off.

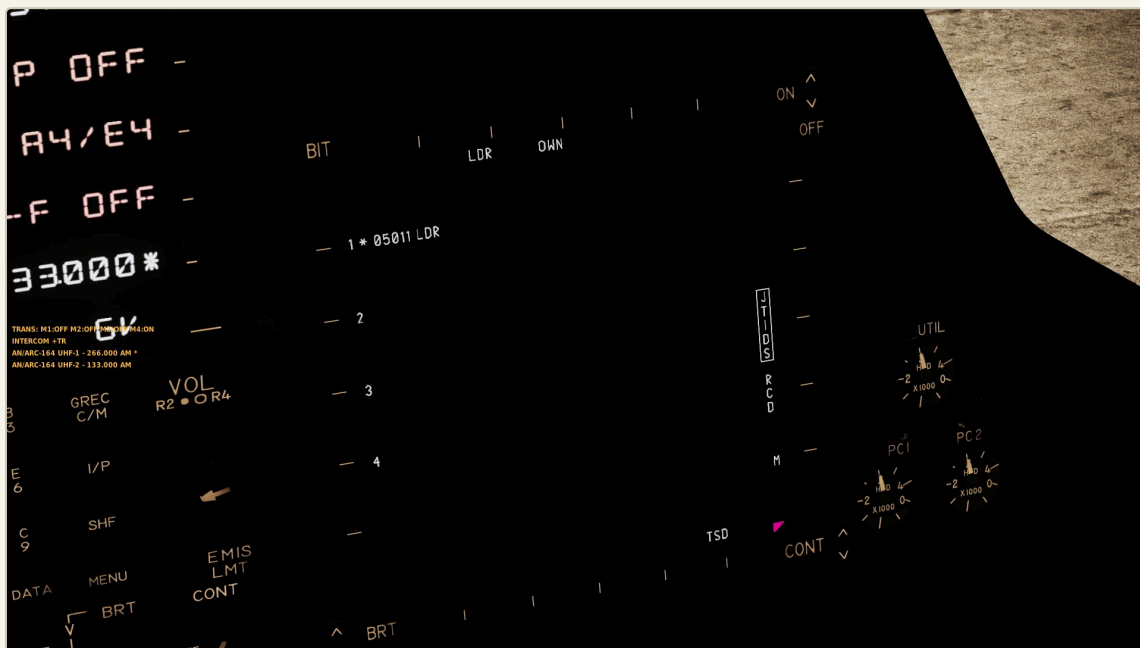
► The JTIDS page — your flight, by track number NEW

Press the JTIDS key (right rail) to swap the SIT for the flight page: four rows, one per slot **1–4**. Each row reads

```
1 * 05001 LDR
2 05002 WNG
```

- the **slot**, then a * on **your own row**,
- that jet's **track number** — always five digits (05001),
- its **role**: LDR for the flight lead, WNG for everyone else.

The rows fill themselves. The page fills in your **mission flight** (up to four) in position order and updates on its own as members join, leave or change slots — in single-player too, with your AI wingmen listed. **Dynamic spawns are not added automatically**; enter them by number (below). A member whose number isn't known yet still keeps his row (2 WNG) and the number appears when it arrives. Press JTIDS again to drop back to the SIT.



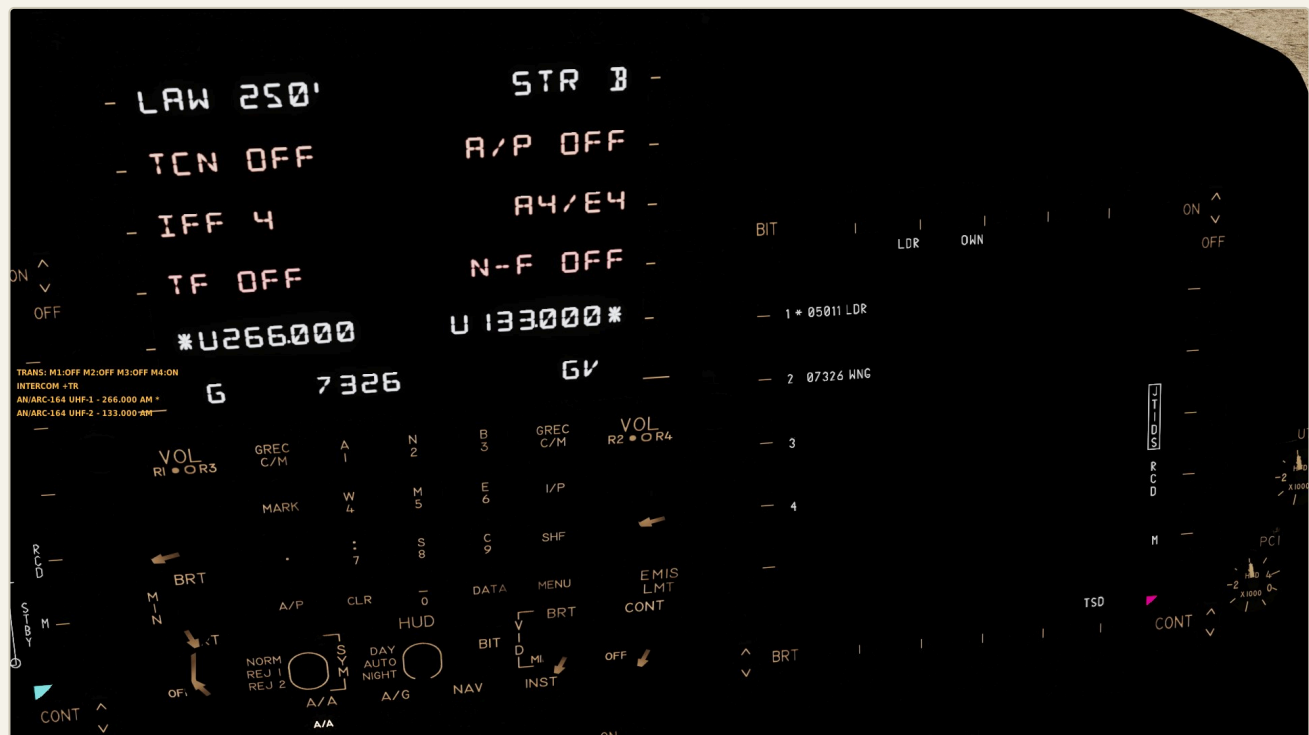
The **JTIDS** page. Row 1 is you — the ***** — with your track number **05011** and **LDR**. Slots 2–4 are empty until the flight fills them or you enter a number. **LDR** and **OWN** sit along the top.

► Where the numbers come from NEW

- **F-15E — its IFF Mode 2 code.** The F-15E has no Link-16 track number in DCS, so this is the number it is known by. The jet generates it, or the mission designer sets it, and it is **fixed for the whole flight**. You can check yours on the **kneeboard**. The jet only sets it once **both engines are running** — that is also what turns the transponder on — so on a cold start your row fills in after engine start. From then on it reaches **every mod user on your side** within a couple of seconds. In the **back seat** the WSO's row shows the same number, taken from the front seat.
- **F-16 / F/A-18 — the Link-16 STN** from the mission: the number the designer set, or otherwise the one DCS assigns, known from mission start. Hover one on the **SIT** or **TSD** and the readout shows it — an F-16 that is 1611 reads TN 01611. Only the mission's number can be read: an STN changed **in the other jet** during the flight (on its TNDL page, for example) is not seen — type the new number in.
- **An AI F-15E, or one flown without the mod,** has no number the app can read. If you know it, type it in.

► Setting a slot yourself NEW

The four slots are the **top four left-rail keys** — slot 1 at the top. To put a number in a slot, type it on the **UFC scratchpad** and press the slot's key. Leading zeros are optional (201 means 00201); digits 0–7 only.



Entering a wingman. 7326 typed on the UFC scratchpad (bottom-left), then the **slot 2** key pressed: row 2 now reads **2 07326 WNG** — padded to five digits, role set automatically. To hand the slot back, type **0** and press the same key.

- **A slot you type into is yours.** It stays exactly as you set it — the automatic picture never overwrites it, even if the flight changes.
- **Type 0 and press the slot** to hand it back. The automatic picture takes the row over again straight away.
- Typing a number for the jet **already in that row** — say your AI wingman — keeps him in the flight and cyan; the row just gains his number. A number that belongs to another known jet attaches to that jet when he appears.
- **You don't have to wait for him.** Enter a wingman's code while he is still starting up; he is picked up as soon as his engines are running and his code is set.
- **Other aircraft can join the flight.** Enter an F-16's STN (1611) and he turns **cyan** on your scope as a member of your flight. You don't get his datalink picture — he isn't running the mod — but JTIDS tracks him as one of yours.
- **When a slot's jet is gone** — say that F-16 is shot down and someone else takes his slot — type 0 into it and the page picks up whoever is there now.
- **Your own row can't be typed over.** To change where you sit, press OWN and then a slot — you move there and stay there.
- LDR then a slot makes that jet the **flight lead**. Only the current lead can hand it on, and the whole flight sees the change.

Everything on this page clears on a **new jet** (respawn / reslot) — every sortie starts with a fresh, automatic flight.

KNOWN LIMIT

A few F-16 track numbers begin with **letters** (in missions with a great many units). Those show correctly when they fill in automatically, but can't be typed on the UFC.

07 Datalink, Donors & the Flight Picture

With **JTIDS** set to **NORM** (§4), the SIT and HMD fill in with a **datalink picture** that reaches well beyond your own radar. Two things feed it: your **flight** (§6), and **donors** — friendly sensors that see a target and share it with you.

► Solid vs. dotted — the one rule that matters

Every contact is drawn one of two ways, and it tells you where the track is coming from:

- **Solid** — your own radar is painting it right now.
- **Dotted** — a **donor** is feeding it to you over the datalink; your own radar is not on it. The shape and colour are the same; only the outline is dotted.

A dotted contact goes **solid** the instant your own radar picks it up, and back to dotted if you sweep off it. Turn your radar off and everything except your cyan flight members goes dotted — that is the pure datalink picture. (Cyan flight members are always solid; their position is a direct broadcast, not a radar reveal.)



Own radar painting the group. The contacts draw as **solid** circles, and the two green scan-limit lines show the radar is sweeping. The cursor is parked on the hostile SA-6, whose details read out bottom-right.

- ▶ Donors — who reveals the picture

- **AWACS** — E-3, E-2, A-50, KJ-2000 and the like. An AWACS reveals a wide circle around itself, and its reach **grows with its altitude** — a Sentry up high covers far more than one down low, and below roughly **10,000 ft it shares nothing**.
- **Ground early-warning radar (EWR)** — a fixed friendly search radar covering the ground around it.

Donors behave like real sensors, not a cheat map. They only reveal what they can actually see: a target must be **above the donor's radar horizon** (a low ground radar can't reveal a deck-level contact 150 nm away), and a donated track **updates on a revisit cadence and coasts between hits** rather than sliding perfectly. Your own radar always stays live and crisp, and a donated contact snaps to live the moment you paint it.

Your **flight members** also share **their own radar** with you (see the dotted picture above), so between the flight and the two donor types you can build a picture with no AWACS at all.

► **Friend or foe — colour & identity**

A contact's colour is its **identity**, and it is only ever set by a real identification — never a god's-eye read of the mission:

- **Green** — positively identified **friendly**.
- **Red** — identified **hostile** (bandit).
- **Yellow** — **unknown**: it has not answered, so it is not assumed friendly. Green requires a positive ID.

Once your radar, a donor, or a flightmate has identified a contact, that call **holds** through scan gaps — a bandit you have ID'd stays red instead of falling back to yellow when you look away, and a friendly can't flash red mid-interrogation. A donor's identification is authoritative: your own radar can't flip a donor-identified contact to the wrong side. A flightmate revealed to you only by a donor still reads **cyan** (flight), not green.

08 Locklines & Target Designation

Everything you and your flight are **working** — the target each jet has locked or designated — is drawn on the SIT and HMD, with a **lockline** tying it back to the jet that owns it. It is how you read, at a glance, who is engaging what.

► Reading a contact — the cursor readout

The SIT carries a slewable acquisition cursor with a fixed readout in the bottom corners. Over open scope it shows **bearing-range from your jet** (bottom-right) and your **bullseye** (bottom-left), both cyan. Park it on a contact and the bottom-right stacks the contact's **identity** (HSTL / FRND / UNKN), its **type**, **altitude** (and ground speed once locked) and **bearing-range**; for a SAM or EWR the bullseye corner adds its **lat-lon and elevation**. The whole block takes the contact's **identity colour** — red hostile, green friendly, yellow unknown, cyan for a flight member. Place the cursor near the contact's centre to capture it.

NOTE • CONTACTS ARE NAMED BY TYPE

The mod ships with a non-cooperative recognition (NCTR) table, so once your radar has looked a contact over it is **named by aircraft type** in the readout out of the box — nothing to install.

► Locklines — who is on what

A **lockline** runs from a jet to the target it has bugged — its Primary Designated Target, or **PDT** (the target you get from an STT lock or a TWS bug):

- **Your own lockline** — a line from your jet to your PDT. If that target is beyond the current range scale the line **clips to the range ring** and points the way to it, rather than vanishing off the edge.
- **A flightmate's air lock** — a **cyan dashed** line from his jet to his PDT, so you can see what each wingman is engaging. It follows his real locked target; no tagging needed.

The bugged target takes its **identity colour** — a bandit you PDT turns **red**, a friendly **green**, an unidentified contact stays **yellow** — read straight from the jet's own identification, reliably in both STT and TWS.



► Designating a ground target

Your designation is **shared with your flight**: a wingman sees your designated ground target as a **green dotted line to a red triangle** carrying your flight number, and you see his. A shared designation **holds steady** for as long as the shooter holds it — it no longer blinks or drops out — and clears the moment he undesignates. Designating an **enemy ship** reveals it to your whole flight the same way.

When the cursor (or a pod line-of-sight / designation) sits on a **SAM or EWR**, that threat's **lat-lon and elevation** show at the bottom-left of the SIT. You can hand that position straight to the jet's **Up-Front Controller (UFC)** as a target point — no manual keying.

1. Slew the cursor onto the SAM so its **lat-lon + elevation appear bottom-left** (whatever is shown there is what transfers).
2. On the UFC, open an **empty target-point slot**.
3. Press the **WPT** key — the **far-left button on the bottom rail**. It keys the threat's latitude, longitude and elevation into the open slot. The **WPT** label appears only when the cursor has a point to send.

SAFETY • EMPTY SLOTS ONLY

The transfer types **only into an empty coordinate slot** — it never overwrites an existing entry. If the open UFC page isn't an empty slot, the button press is ignored. You choose the slot; the app only fills it.

A companion key, **SAMX** (just left of the HMD button), **hides the SAM or EWR the cursor has snapped onto** — useful for clearing a threat you have already dealt with off a busy scope. Its label shows only when a SAM/EWR is under the cursor.

► Threat rings on the TSD moving map **NEW**

The SAM and EWR picture is not confined to the SIT — the same **threat rings** are painted over the jet's own **TSD moving map**, in scale with the chart, so your route and the threats that bracket it sit in one view. Each site draws its lethal ring at the correct world radius and carries its type designator at the centre, and the rings keep showing with **JTIDS off** (they come from your data cartridge, not the datalink).

The colour is the same warning rule as the SIT: a ring is **yellow** while you are outside it and turns **red** the moment your jet crosses inside its lethal range.



Threat rings over the TSD. All four are **yellow** – the jet is outside every lethal ring. The top-left softkey is carrying **WPT**.

NOTE • THE TSD CARRIES WPT AND SAMX TOO

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09 The Targeting Pod

If you carry the F-15E's targeting pod, the mod shows where the pod is looking and what it has designated — on both the SIT and the HMD — and drives the pod's air-to-air modes.

► Pod line-of-sight & designation on the SIT

The pod's markers are a **separate sensor** from the A/A and A/G radar and coexist with the radar cursor:



TGP LOS – white crosshair

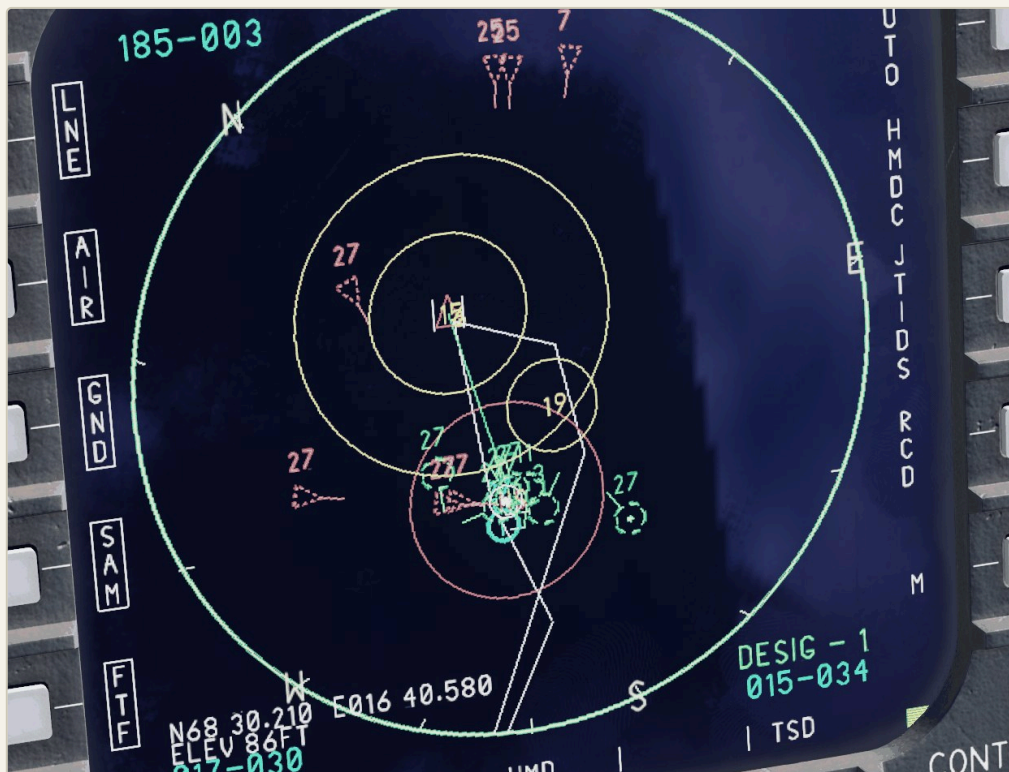
Marks the point the pod is looking at; tracks live as you slew the pod, and shows whenever the pod has a valid ground line-of-sight.



Designation – red triangle with a green lock line

Marks your pod-designated point, with a line running back to your jet. It stays on that ground point until you undesignate or designate elsewhere. One at a time.

Both markers clip to the scope ring. When the pod's LOS or your designation falls on a ground/sea contact (a SAM, say) the marker **snaps onto that contact** and its details fill the cursor readout. The pod's LOS and designation also appear on the HMD — see §10.



A designated ground point on the SIT. The marker is a red apex-up triangle with a green lock line running back to your jet, so you can see at a glance what you are designating and where it sits against the threat rings and your route. The cursor has captured it: bottom-left gives the point's lat-lon and elevation (N68 30.210 / E016 40.580 / ELEV 86 FT) – ready to send to the UFC with **WPT** – and bottom-right labels it **DESIG - 1**, the designation belonging to flight member 1.



The same designation seen through the helmet. Out in the world, four **corner brackets** mark where the pod is looking and the **diamond** inside them is the designated ground point – the same point the SIT draws as the red triangle. The **boresight cross** sits just up and right of it, showing where your head is pointed. Note the lower-right readout has flipped to **TGT**: the jet's own HUD switches that line from nav steering to target steering the moment something is designated. This is air-to-ground, so the heading shows as the **scrolling tape** across the top rather than the two boxed values the air-to-air layout uses.

► Air-to-air pod tracking NEW

Lock an air target — an STT lock, or a TWS priority-designated target — and the pod **slews to and tracks the bandit**, following it as it manoeuvres and jumping to the new target when you cycle the PDT. It lets the crew get eyes on and visually identify a contact at range.

NEW The pod switches itself to **A/A only while the radar has a designated target**. With no PDT it stays in **A/G**, where you can slew it by hand, and when the PDT goes away it returns to A/G after about two seconds. It switches **once per change** and only when the pod is actually in the wrong mode, so it never fights you — and it works whether the radar or the pod is in command.



The pod riding the PDT. Left MPD: the A/A radar with an **F-14** bugged as the designated target. Right MPD: the pod has slewed itself off-boresight to it – **AZ 038L / EL 005U** – and is holding the aircraft in the centre of the crosshair, close enough to identify by shape. Nothing was slewed by hand; the pod followed the lock.

► **EXP zoom** NEW

Box EXP and step the field of view to 5× or 8× to narrow the pod's view and zoom in — in **both air-to-ground and air-to-air**.

► **Advanced pod features — on by default** NEW

The full pod feature set — the EXP optical zoom, infra-red handling, video de-blur, and the zoom-level label — ships **enabled out of the box**. There is nothing to switch on.

10 The HMD

Contacts, threats, and waypoints out in the world at their real bearings, in HUD-green. Works on a flat monitor, with TrackIR, and in **VR**.

NOTE • FRONT SEAT ONLY

The helmet is a **pilot (front-seat)** display. In the WSO back seat it is hidden — see §12 · [The WSO Back Seat](#). An HMD left on up front comes back on when you return to the front.

► Turning it on

The HMD is toggled by the **ON/OFF** button — the **bottom-center OSB** on the SIT page bezel. Press to show, press again to hide. Like the other SIT controls it is page-aware: it only acts while that MFD is showing the SIT page. A quick one-press calibration lines the helmet up with your HUD so the readouts hand off cleanly — and **NEW** the **first time you turn the HMD on each session it prompts you to calibrate automatically** (when you've bound a center key; see [Calibrating the HMD center](#) below). Shows only in the **cockpit view**; hidden in external views (F2/F4/flyby).

► The visor gate (Use Visor for HMD) **NEW**

A real helmet display projects onto the **lowered visor**, and the app now works the same way. With the visor **up**, nothing helmet-related draws — not the contacts, not the boresight cross, not even the calibrate crosshair. Lower the visor and the **ON/OFF** button decides as before.

The two controls are independent, which is the point: you can fly with the visor down and the symbology **off** by pressing **ON/OFF**, exactly as you could before. The visor simply adds a second condition — **both** must be true for the helmet to show.

The visor is **not a clickable cockpit control**. The only way to raise and lower it is the DCS keybind “**Helmet Visor/NVG Toggle**”, under the F-15E controls. The app watches *that same button*: it reads your DCS bindings on first run and configures itself, so there is nothing to set up. One press lowers the real visor and tells the app at the same moment, so the two can never disagree.

IF THE HMD SEEMS DEAD — CHECK THE VISOR BIND FIRST

If you have **not bound** “Helmet Visor/NVG Toggle” in DCS, you have no way to lower the visor — so the helmet stays gated and pressing **ON/OFF** appears to do nothing. Either bind it (DCS → **Controls** → F-15E → search *visor*), or turn the gate off in the tray.

To go back to the old behaviour, uncheck **Use Visor for HMD** in the tray menu. The **ON/OFF** button then decides on its own and the visor is ignored entirely. It is **on by default**, and unlike most tray options it applies **immediately** — no DCS restart.

► What it shows

A small **boresight cross** marks straight ahead. Around it, out in the world:

The helmet works in **any master mode** — A/A, A/G and NAV alike. What it draws is deliberately narrow: **airborne contacts**, to keep the air picture clean. Ground and sea threats — **SAMs, EWR, ships** — stay on the **SIT page** rather than cluttering the view outside. Your **flight-plan waypoints** can be added with the helmet's own **WPT** filter (off by default; they draw in NAV mode) — see §11 · [HMD filters](#) — the [HMDC page](#).

- **Air contacts** — each carries its short **type designator** above the symbol, and the **shape** tells you the side:
 - **Hostile** — a **diamond**.
 - **Friendly** — a **circle**.
 - **Unknown** — a **box**.
 - Members of **your own flight** — a **cyan circle** with their **flight number** (**1**–**4**) inside, in place of a type.
- **A flightmate's bugged target** — when a wingman locks or designates an air target, it shows in your helmet **over the bogey** with his **flight number** and the bogey's **altitude**, so you can look straight at what he is engaging.

As on the SIT, a contact your **own radar** is painting draws **solid**; one only a **donor** is feeding you draws **dotted**. Turn your radar off and the helmet shows the donor picture, dotted, just like the SIT.



The helmet cue with a bandit locked. The bugged target sits in the **lock box** mid-frame, its altitude (27 = 27,000 ft) beside it; up and left, a **dotted** circle marks a contact only a donor is feeding you. Around them the jet's own HUD readouts have come off the glass with your head: airspeed (528) and angle of attack (α 12.2) left, altitude (18680) right, master mode, Mach and G lower-left, and target range and time-to-go (R 25.6 / 31 SEC) lower-right. In air-to-air the heading shows as two boxed values rather than a tape: your **aircraft** heading (030) at the top, your **helmet** heading (333) at the bottom — where the jet is pointed, and where you are looking.

Each contact shows its **range** (nm) on the left and **altitude** (thousands of feet) on the right — the same data layout as the SIT page.

To keep the view readable, symbols draw only where you can actually use them — within the cone your head is looking through, or across the HUD — rather than scattered over the whole canopy.

You can filter what the helmet draws and set its range gate independently of the SIT — see §11 · HMD filters — the HMDC page.

► Targeting-pod LOS & designation on the HMD

If you carry the **targeting pod (LITENING / TGP)**, the HMD also shows where the pod is looking and any designated point — out in the world, where your head is pointed:

- **Pod line-of-sight — a green box.** A corner-bracket box — the F-15E's own TPOD box — marks the ground point the pod is currently looking at; follows it live as you slew the pod. **Off-HUD only** (the HUD already draws it on the glass). Appears when the pod is on the ground; hidden when the pod points at the sky.

- **Designation — a green diamond.** When you **designate** a target, a green diamond drops on that ground point and stays **pinned** there as you fly, until you undesignate. It matches the diamond the HUD itself draws, so — like the pod box — it shows **off-HUD only**, handing off to the HUD's own diamond as you look through the glass. It marks the same point as the SIT page's designation.

► **Designate where you look**

In air-to-ground, with the **HUD in command** (castle the HUD to SOI), put the helmet boresight on a ground point and press **Coolie Switch DOWN** to slew and designate there — a short press slews, a longer press slews *and* designates, dropping the mark right where you are looking. When the **targeting pod** is in command instead, Coolie DOWN designates the pod's own point and the helmet cross stays out of the way. Bind Coolie DOWN in §13.

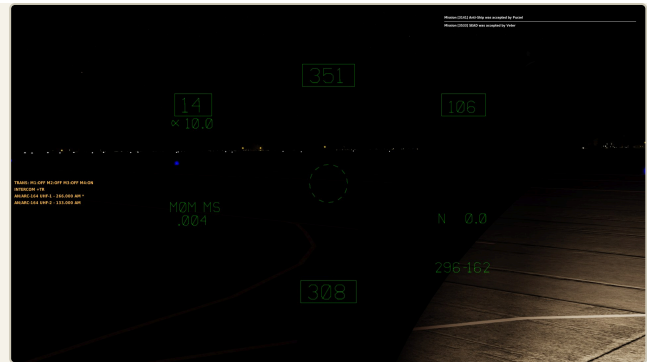
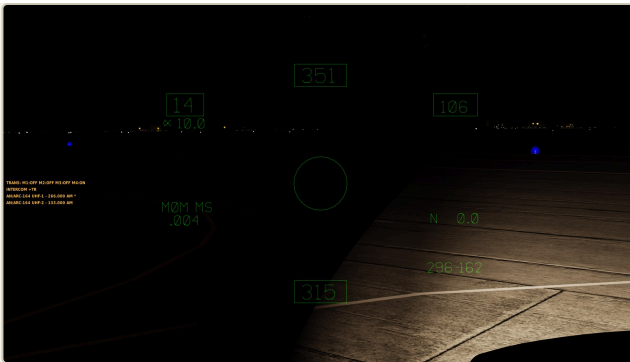
► **Air-to-air: boresight where you look** NEW

In an **air-to-air** master mode, with the HMD on, the helmet can aim the radar's boresight — look at a bandit, and boresight acquires him. It works in **BST** and **LR BST** only; it does **not** work in SS, VST or guns.

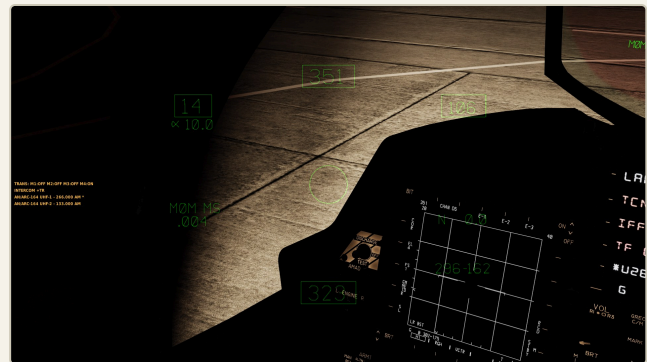
- **Coolie DOWN, held — helmet aiming on / off.** A small **inner circle** appears where you are looking. While it is on, the radar's boresight looks where your helmet looks instead of straight off the nose.
- **Coolie DOWN, short press — straight to BST.** Puts the radar into **ACM boresight** in one press — the same as working the Auto-Acq switch by hand (down, forward, forward), without cycling through the other modes mid-fight.

The circle tells you whether the radar can lock where you are looking:

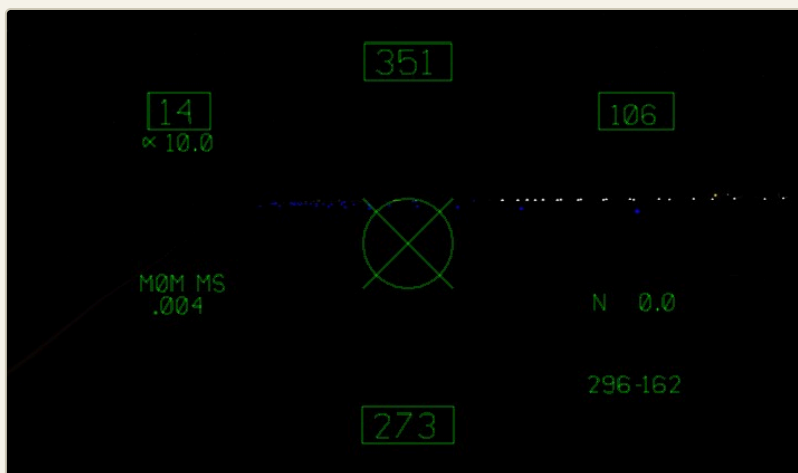
- **Dashed** — it **can't** lock anything: the radar is not in BST or LR BST. Press Coolie DOWN (short) to get there.
- **Solid** — the radar is in BST or LR BST and looking where you look. Put the circle on the bandit.
- **Larger** for BST (10 NM), **smaller** for LR BST (40 NM), matching the radar's own.
- **Crossed out (X)** — you are looking further off the nose than the antenna can turn. The circle stays where you are looking so you can see how far to come back.



Can it lock? Left: **solid** – the radar is in BST and looking where you look. Right: **dashed** – the radar is in another mode and can't lock there; a short Coolie DOWN takes it to BST.



Two sizes, matching the radar. Left: the radar page (lower right) reads **BST** at **10 NM** – the **larger** circle. Right: **LR BST** at **40 NM** – the **smaller** one.



Too far off the nose. The jet is on **351** (top) but you are looking at **273** (bottom) – nearly 80° left, past where the antenna can turn – so the circle is **crossed out**. Bring your head back toward the nose until the X clears.

Once the radar **locks**, its tracker owns the antenna and the helmet stops steering it.

AFTER YOU UNLOCK

Unlocking drops the radar out of ACM boresight. Press Coolie DOWN (short) to go straight back to BST — otherwise you have to cycle the Auto-Acq switch forward.

AMRAAM ring. With the **MRM** selected, the missile's dotted acquisition ring is drawn in the helmet as it appears on the HUD. It hides while you look through the HUD, where the jet draws its own, and clears with the jet.

▶ **Target Locator Line**

Lock a bandit (STT or TWS) that is **outside your helmet's field of view** — off to the side or behind you — and a line from the boresight cross **points the way to it**, so you know which way to turn your head or the jet to bring it into view. It's a helmet pointer, so it carries **no degrees**. The moment the locked contact comes back into your view, the line gives way to the lock box that marks the target directly.

▶ **Off-HUD readouts**

When you look **away from the HUD** (off the nose), the HMD brings the jet's own HUD readouts with you — pulled **straight from the F-15E HUD**, so they read exactly as they do on the glass:

- **Airspeed** on the left, with **Mach** (e.g. **M .98**) just below it.
- **Altitude** on the right, split into **High / Low** the same way the HUD shows it.
- **Angle of attack** (**α**), **master mode**, and **G load**.
- **Nav / steerpoint** info, including the **steerpoint bearing**.
- A **heading tape** across the top that scrolls with where your head is pointed (your **look-heading**), with a caret marking center.

They blank out when you look back through the HUD — the real HUD is already showing them — and reappear when you look away. Calibrating the HMD center (next) makes that hand-off crisp.

▶ **Calibrating the HMD center (CLBR)**

DCS never tells the app where your HUD sits on screen, so out of the box the helmet lines up with the jet's **nose** — close, but the real HUD sits a little below that, which can make the off-HUD readouts vanish a touch early near the top of the HUD. A quick **once-per-session** calibration lines the two up so the readouts stay put right to the HUD edge and hand off cleanly.

1. **Bind a center key first** — tray → **Controls...** → **HMD Center** (a HOTAS button or a keyboard key).
2. **Lower your visor** — with **Use Visor for HMD** on (the default), the calibrate crosshair is gated by the visor just like the rest of the helmet symbology. You calibrate looking *through* the visor, which is where the symbology actually is. See [The visor gate](#) above.

3. In the cockpit, press **CLBR** — the **3rd button down the left rail** of the SIT page, below **CTL** and **HMD**. A green crosshair and *"LOOK HUD CTR — PRESS CENTER"* appear, and the helmet symbology hides. (The CLBR label boxes while it's armed.)
4. Look straight at the **center of your HUD** and press your bound center key. The crosshair **disappears** — that's your confirmation it captured.

The helmet is now centered on your actual HUD. It's remembered for the session and nothing is written to disk — recalibrate (press CLBR again) after you restart DCS, or any time the hand-off doesn't look right.

NOTE • FIRST-TIME CALIBRATION IS AUTOMATIC

NEW

The **first time you turn the HMD on each session**, the app arms this calibration for you — the crosshair and *"LOOK HUD CTR — PRESS CENTER"* appear straight away, so all you do is look at the HUD center and press your bound key. This only happens when you've **bound an HMD Center key** (tray → **Controls...**); with nothing bound there's nothing to press, so the prompt is skipped. If the crosshair ever appears and you're not ready — or you haven't bound a key yet — press **CLBR** to dismiss it.

► Hidden behind your cockpit

Symbols that fall behind the canopy bow, glareshield, or cockpit frame are **occluded** by the structure, not overlaid on it.

► In VR

Works in VR: per-eye at correct size and depth — including with **foveated rendering / Quad Views** — sits behind the cockpit as above, and reads at the same brightness as your HUD (next).

The rendering runtime the VR features rely on is installed **automatically** — you don't turn anything on for the SIT page or the HMD to show up in the headset.

► Crisp HMD in VR — **VR Enabled**

For the sharpest helmet symbology, turn on **VR Enabled** in the tray menu and restart DCS. This registers a small **OpenXR layer** that paints the cue *after* DCS finishes upscaling the frame — so the symbology stays sharp even when **DLSS** and **foveated / Quad Views** render the world at a lower internal resolution. With it off, the HMD still works, but on lower-resolution rigs the cue is drawn *before* upscaling and can look soft or smeared.

Switching it on shows a one-time **Windows administrator prompt** — that's just the layer being registered. If you miss or decline it, the app quietly re-offers it the next time you launch, so there's never any need to "run as administrator" yourself.

NOTE • HMD NOT SHARP IN THE HEADSET?

Make sure **VR Enabled** is **on**, that you approved the administrator prompt, and that you **restarted DCS** afterwards. When the layer is active the helmet cue is crisp at any render resolution; if it still looks soft, the layer isn't loading — leave **VR Enabled** on and relaunch, and it will re-register itself.

► **Tuning the VR HMD** — **HMD VR...**

With **VR Enabled** on, the tray's **HMD VR...** window fine-tunes the helmet view for your headset. Drag a slider and the change shows **live in the headset**; the current value reads out on the right.

- **HMD Size** — overall size of the helmet chrome (readouts, heading tape, boresight cross).
- **HMD Text Size** — size of the HMD text / readout elements, independent of the chrome.
- **Line Strength** — line thickness. **1.0** is the automatic, resolution-based default; raise it if lines look thin or broken on a lower-resolution headset (e.g. Quest 2), lower it if they read too heavy.

OK saves your values; **Cancel** (or closing the window) reverts to what they were when you opened it; **Reset to defaults** restores the shipped values. The sliders only affect the OpenXR-layer HMD, so if **VR Enabled** isn't on yet, **HMD VR...** tells you to enable it first.

► **Brightness — tracks your HUD knob**

The HMD dims and brightens with the F-15E **HUD Brightness** knob, down to **off** at the bottom.

NOTE • SCREENSHOT WITH THE OVERLAY**NEW**

Press your **screenshot key** to save a capture that *includes* the HMD and SIT overlay (you also get DCS's own pre-overlay shot). The key defaults to **PrintScreen** and is **rebindable** in **Controls...** — set it to **Clear (off)** there to turn the feature off. Files land in your **Saved Games\...\ScreenShots** folder, timestamped so they never overwrite.

► **Recording or streaming the HMD in VR**

Capturing your **flat DCS mirror window** in OBS (Game or Window Capture) already includes the HMD and SIT overlay — nothing extra to do.

Some streamers instead record the true in-headset view with an **OpenXR mirror** capture such as **OpenXR OBS Mirror**. With that method the DCS world records fine but the **HMD cue can be missing** from the recording — even though it's perfectly sharp in your headset. That's an ordering quirk: the mirror layer copies each eye image *before* our overlay paints the cue into it. One-time fix, using **OpenXR API Layers GUI** (the standard tool for ordering OpenXR layers):

1. Move **ModernF15E's** layer (**XR_API_LAYER_MODERNF15E_hmd_overlay**) **above** the OBS mirror layer (**XR_API_LAYER_NOVENDOR_OBSMirror**) — higher in the list runs first, so our cue is painted before OBS

copies the frame.

2. If you use **foveated rendering / Quad Views**, keep ModernF15E **below** that layer ([OpenXR-Quad-Views-Foveated](#)) so the cue still lands on the finished image.
3. Restart DCS and OBS — the cue now records.

This only affects OpenXR mirror capture; your headset view and flat-window capture are never affected.

11 Filters & Views

The SIT page's controls sit as OSB (Option Select Button) labels around the MFD bezel, in the F-15E convention: a control is **boxed/inverted when it is active**, and each label only acts while that MFD is showing the SIT page. The **main page** stays uncluttered — the mode keys (**AUTO**, **JTIDS**, **RCD**, **M**), the **FRZ** freeze key, the **HMD** toggle on the bottom-centre, the **CTL** (SIT filters) and **HMDC** (HMD filters) page keys, the **CLBR** HMD-centre calibrate (§10), and — on the bottom rail — the **WPT** coordinate-transfer and **SAMX** hide-threat keys (§8), which appear only when there is something for them to do. The **contact filters** live one button away, on the filter pages those keys open (below).

► The scope layout

The SIT has a single view, identical at every range. Your jet sits low on the scope and the picture expands forward, giving you the widest look-ahead view in front of you. The **compass rose** is the large ring centered in the display: **N**, **E**, **S** and **W** sit on the ring itself, the intercardinals carry their heading (**45**, **135**, **225**, **315**) just outside it, and short ticks mark every 10°. The card is heading-up and reads **magnetic**, matching your HSI. The ring never resizes — only how far out contacts plot changes with the selected range.

Two green lines from your jet mark the **radar scan limits**. They reach **half the selected range** — 40 nm on an 80 nm scope — so they double as a range reference. They appear whenever the A/A radar is scanning, and disappear in STT (the lock line carries the picture instead).

► Range & bullseye readouts

Your selected **range** sits **top-right** (green); your **bullseye** — bearing and range from the mission bullseye — sits **top-left**. Range steps through a fixed ladder — **5, 10, 20, 40, 80, 160, 240** nm, default **80 nm** — set from your HOTAS (below). Bullseye bearings read **magnetic**, matching the HUD.

► The cursor — AUTO vs. manual

The SIT carries a slewable acquisition cursor (its readout is covered in §8). The **AUTO** key picks how the cursor behaves, and it is **on by default each time you fly**:

CURSOR MODES — THE AUTO KEY

MODE	BEHAVIOUR
AUTO on (default)	The SIT is slaved to the A/A radar : range scale and cursor follow the radar's designation. The cursor appears only when the A/A radar is the Sensor of Interest (SOI). No HOTAS binding needed.
AUTO off	Independent manual mode : you slew the cursor with your HOTAS (see §13). Slewing to the top scope edge bumps range up, the bottom edge down. The cursor is always present.

► **Range and zoom — your HOTAS**

Range and zoom are driven entirely from the **Auto Acquisition Switch** on your HOTAS — there are no range or zoom buttons on the bezel. While the SIT is your **Sensor Of Interest (SOI)**:

AUTO ACQUISITION SWITCH ON THE SIT

SWITCH	ACTION
FWD	Range in — one step closer.
AFT	Range out — one step further.
PRESS	Toggle the cursor-centered zoom .

The steps are **5 / 10 / 20 / 40 / 80 / 160 / 240 nm**, and the ladder **wraps** — step out past 240 nm and you land on 5, step in past 5 and you land on 240. You never have to notice which end you hit and reverse.

With **AUTO** on, the radar slaves the scope range and range steps are ignored — the radar would overwrite them on its next update. Turn **AUTO** off to set range yourself.

► **Zoom**

PRESS on the Auto Acquisition Switch snaps the scope to a fixed **10 nm view centered on your TDC cursor**, regardless of the selected range. Press again to return to your previous view and range.

Park the cursor over what you want to inspect, then zoom to blow that area up. While zoomed the latched point sits at the center of the display and every contact re-plots relative to it, so edge range-bumping is suspended until you zoom back out. The scan-limit lines are hidden in zoom — your jet is off-center there, so they would point from the wrong place.

No setup needed — this auto-configures from your existing DCS “Auto Acquisition Switch FWD/AFT/PRESS” bindings. Each flick is a single step (holding does not repeat). Because it only acts while the SIT is SOI, it never clashes with the switch's normal radar auto-acquisition — the SIT and the radar can't both be SOI at once, so the switch simply follows whichever you're using.

► **Freeze — the FRZ button**

The **FRZ** OSB on the **top-left button** freezes the SIT picture. Press it and the tactical snapshot — your jet, every contact, and the bullseye — holds in place as of that instant; the label boxes to show freeze is on. Press it again to thaw and resume the live picture.

FREEZE BEHAVIOR

MODE WHILE FROZEN

AUTO on The picture is held and the cursor stays put — there's nothing to slew, and the radar can't bump the range.

AUTO off You can still **slew the cursor** over the frozen picture and **bump the range** (slew to a scope edge) to study or measure it.

Freeze is handy for studying a busy picture or lining the cursor up on a threat to send to the UFC without the scene moving under you.

► Filters — the CTL page

Press **CTL** and the SIT swaps to a **filter page** where each bezel button toggles a **category of contact** on or off (boxed when it is being shown). The top-left button now reads **SIT** and takes you **back** — and the moment you return, every button restores to its normal job. The categories are grouped by family:

- **Friendly air**, split by type — friendly **fighters**, **AWACS**, **tankers & other**, and your own **flight**.
- **Hostile air** and **naval** (sea) contacts.
- Flight-plan **waypoints** and friendly **airfields**.
- **SAM threats** — a master toggle plus **long / medium / short-range** class filters. Turn the SAM master **off** and all three classes clear with it; turn it back **on** and the class toggles refine which threat ranges you see — hide the long-range strategic SAMs and keep the short-range pop-ups, or the reverse.

NOTE • CONTROLS ARE PAGE-AWARE

The SIT page's OSBs (AUTO and the type filters) only act when that MFD is actually showing the SIT page. Pressing the same physical button while the MFD is on another format will not trigger a SIT control.

► HMD filters — the HMDC page

The **HMDC** key opens a **second filter page that controls the HMD cue only**. It is laid out **identically to the CTL page** — the same friendly, category, and SAM-threat toggles — but it filters what you see on the **helmet**, independently of the SIT scope. Cut the helmet down to hostiles and SAMs while the SIT still shows the full picture, or the reverse. **SIT** (top-left) takes you back.

One control the CTL page doesn't have sits in the top-left corner (FRZ's spot on the main page):

HMDC PAGE — ADDED CONTROL

OSB

DOES

RNG

The HMD **range gate** — how far out the helmet draws contacts. Each press steps 80 → 60 → 40 → 80 nm. Helmet only; the SIT range ring is separate.

NOTE • TWO INDEPENDENT FILTERS

CTL filters the **SIT scope**; **HMDC** filters the **HMD cue**. They are separate sets — a contact hidden on one still shows on the other. Both start with everything on.

12 The WSO Back Seat

Everything works in the two-seat F-15E from either cockpit — with a few back-seat differences.

► Front seat vs. back seat

- The **HMD is front-seat only**. In the WSO pit the helmet cue, the calibrate cross and the **HMD** / **HMDC** keys are hidden, so the back-seater gets a clean SIT. It is only hidden — an HMD left on up front comes back on when you move back to the front, and it tracks live if you jump between seats.
- The **SIT, flight picture, datalink, locklines and designations are identical** in both seats — the WSO sees the same slotted flight and the same tactical picture as the pilot.
- **NEW** On the **JTIDS page** the WSO's own row carries the jet's track number, taken from the front seat (the back seat can't read the IFF itself). Slots the **pilot types in by hand** are not yet shared with the back seat.

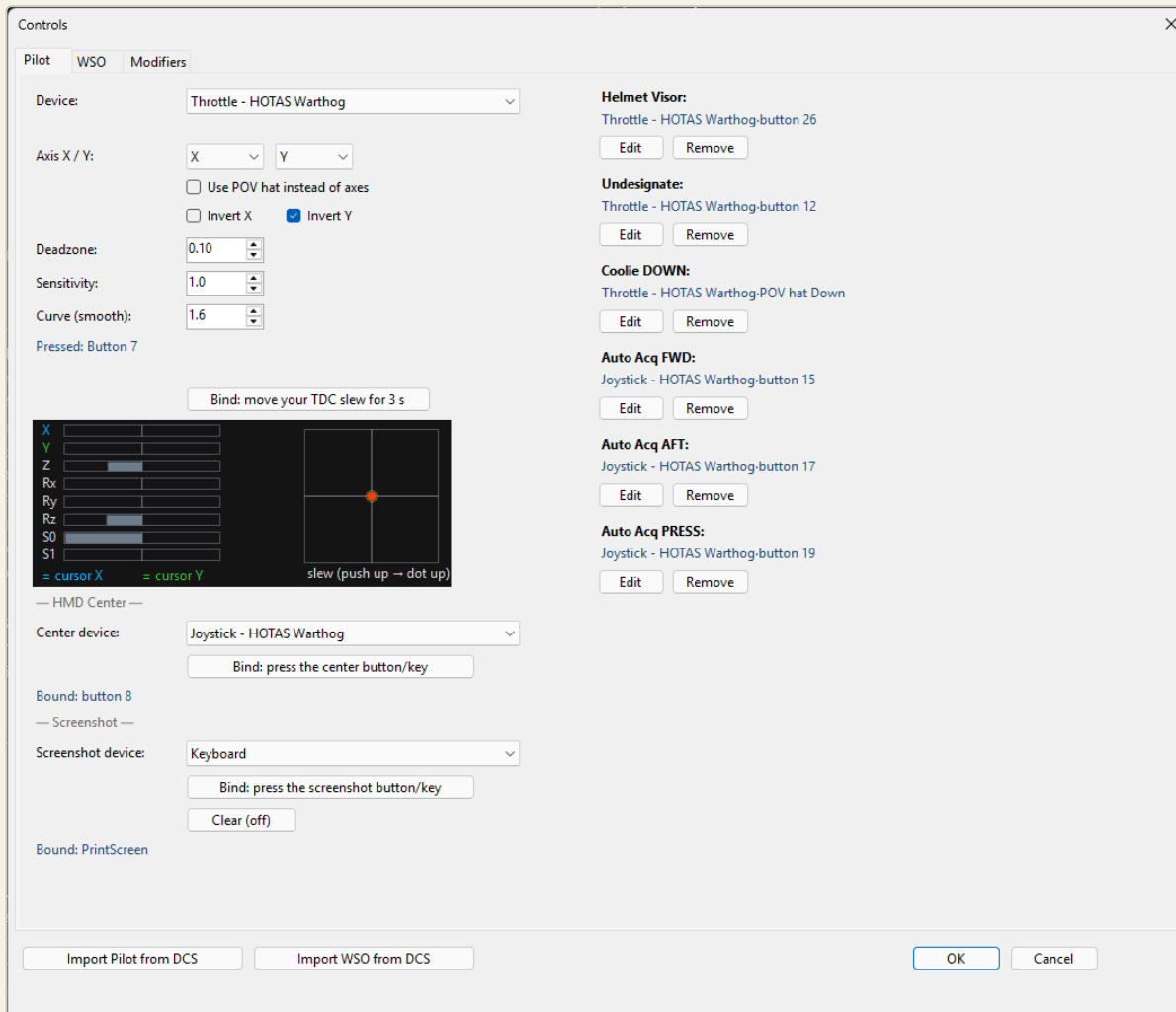
► The hand controllers

In the back seat each **hand controller drives the display on its own side**: the left hand controller (LHC) slews the SIT/TSD cursor on the **left** MPD, the right (RHC) on the **right**. Working the A/G radar on one side no longer throws a stray designation onto the other, and nudging the Auto-Acq switch no longer rescales the SIT.

Every back-seat control — the hand-controller slews, half-action, undesignates and designates — can be bound to a HOTAS *or* to the **keyboard** (§13), so a WSO flying without hand-controller hardware can still drive the SIT.

13 Controls & Bindings

The tray's **Controls...** dialog is where you bind the SIT-cursor slew, the HMD-centre calibrate key, the screenshot key, the Coolie / designate controls and the WSO hand-controller binds. It reads your devices live and opens instantly — **Keyboard** is available immediately while your joysticks fill into the **Device** list a moment later. Changes apply **immediately** on **OK** — no restart.



The **Controls** dialog. The **left column** sets up the cursor slew for the selected device – axes, deadzone, sensitivity, curve and invert – with a live visualiser underneath that confirms *push-up → dot up*, followed by the **HMD Center** and **Screenshot** binds. The **right column** lists every other command with what it is currently bound to. The **Pilot**, **WSO** and **Modifiers** tabs at the top hold the front-seat binds, the back-seat hand-controller binds (§12) and your named modifiers.

Controls

Pilot **WSO** **Modifiers**

The F-15E WSO has two hand controllers (LHC + RHC). Bind each control on the controller you use — either controller's press fires the action, and your pilot binds keep working unchanged.

— Left Hand Controller (LHC) —

— TDC Slew (LHC) —

Device: (none)

Bound: (none) — this controller unbound.

LHC Half Action:
(not set)

Add Remove

LHC Undesignate:
(not set)

Add Remove

LHC Designate:
Throttle - HOTAS Warthog-button 1

Edit Remove

— Right Hand Controller (RHC) —

— TDC Slew (RHC) —

Device: (none)

Bound: (none) — this controller unbound.

RHC Half Action:
(not set)

Add Remove

RHC Undesignate:
(not set)

Add Remove

RHC Designate:
(not set)

Add Remove

Import Pilot from DCS Import WSO from DCS OK Cancel

The **WSO** tab, laid out as the back seat is: the **left hand controller** on the left, the **right** on the right, each with its own slew device and its own **Half Action**, **Undesignate** and **Designate** binds — matching the way each controller drives the MPD on its own side (§12). Bind only the controller you actually fly with; either one's press fires the action, and nothing here disturbs your pilot binds. Anything left (not set) is simply unused.

► Slewing the SIT cursor — three ways

Pick your **Device** first; the dialog then shows the controls for that kind of device.

SLEW METHODS

METHOD	HOW YOU SET IT UP
Analog axes (a slew / TDC axis pair)	Pick the joystick, then set Axis X / Y — or click <code>Bind: move your TDC slew for 3 s</code> to auto-detect the two most-moved axes. Tune with Deadzone , Sensitivity , Curve and Invert X / Y (throttle slews usually want Invert Y so push-up moves the cursor up). A calibration box confirms <i>push-up</i> → <i>dot up</i> .
Four buttons / POV hat	No slew axis on your stick? Bind four discrete directions instead — a POV hat or four separate buttons for up / down / left / right.
Keyboard	Choose Keyboard for a four-key bind panel. Keyboard slew is live only while DCS is focused and you're in an F-15E , so the keys stay free everywhere else.

`Import Pilot from DCS` and `Import WSO from DCS`, along the bottom of the dialog, auto-fill whichever method you already set up in DCS for that seat — your F-15E TDC Slew axis, the four-way TDC Switch buttons, or your keyboard TDC keys.

► HMD Center & Screenshot

- **HMD Center** — the button or key you press to line the helmet up with the HUD during CLBR calibration (§10).
- **Screenshot** — the key that saves a capture *including* the overlay. Defaults to **PrintScreen**; rebind it, or set `Clear (off)` to turn it off.

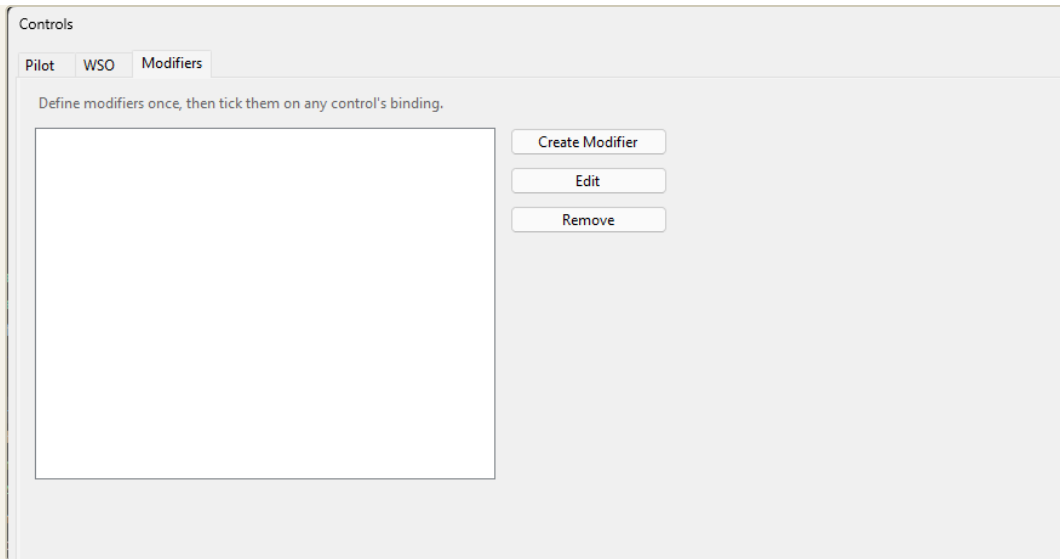
► Coolie & designate binds

The **Coolie Switch DOWN** (for HMD look-designate — designate where you look with the HUD in command) and every WSO control can be bound to a HOTAS button or to the keyboard, each with an optional modifier.

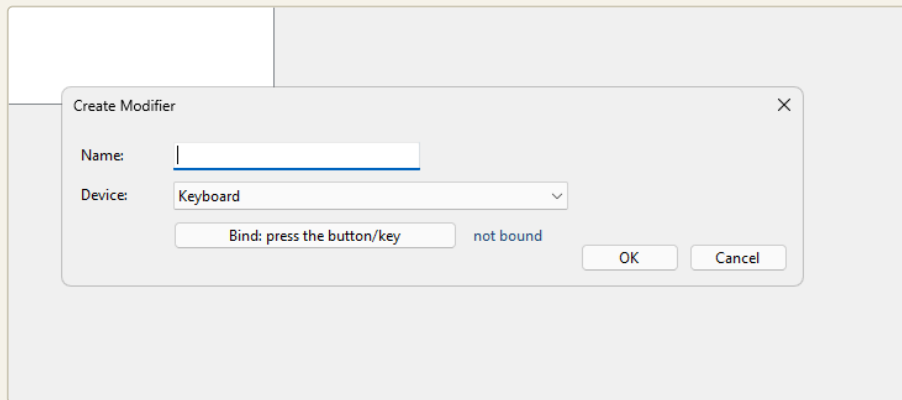
► Modifier keys — the DCS way NEW

You can require a "hold this too" modifier on the mod's controls, exactly like DCS. Define a modifier **once by name** on the **Modifiers** tab (pick any controller or the keyboard and press the button), then **tick it onto** any binding — the control then fires only when its button *and* every ticked modifier are held. A modifier can live on a **different device** than the control it modifies, and your DCS `modifiers.lua` is imported automatically, so the tab is already populated when you open Controls.

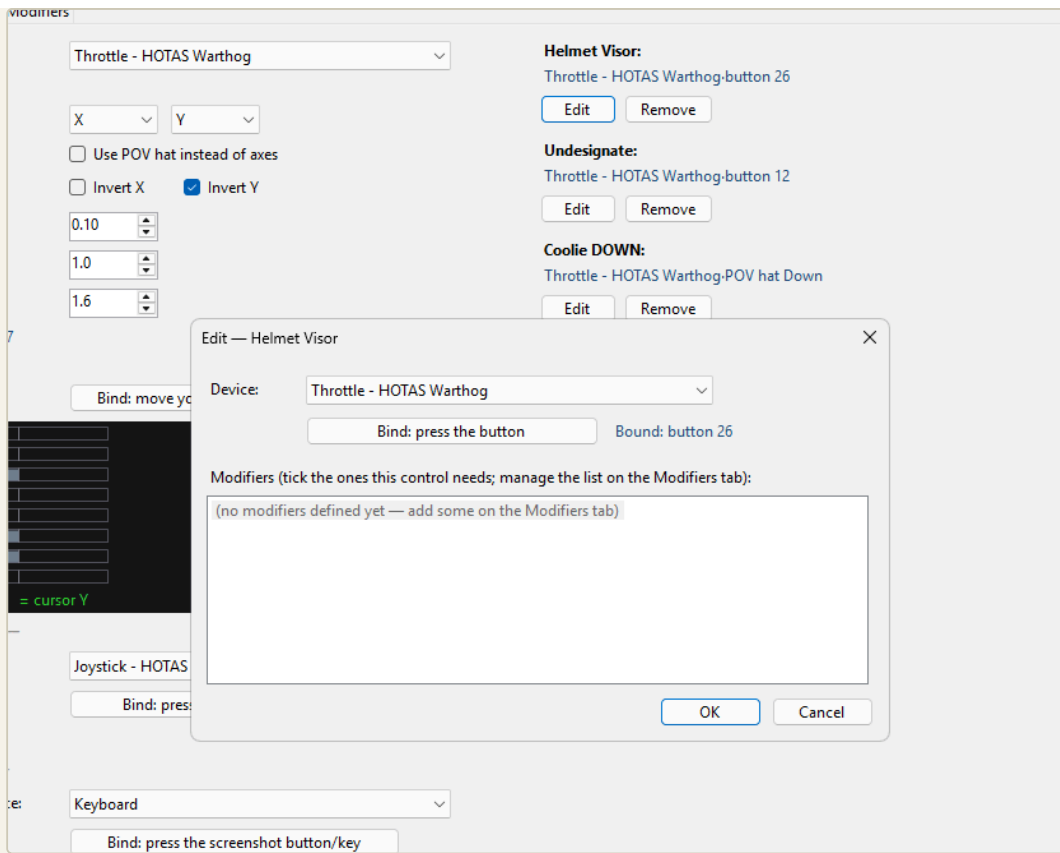
It is three steps, one per screen below.



1 • The Modifiers tab. Every modifier you have lives in this one list – the ones imported from DCS included. It is empty here because none are defined yet. Press **Create Modifier** to add one.



2 • Name it and bind it. Give the modifier a **name** you will recognise in the tick list, pick the **device** it lives on – any controller, or the keyboard – and press **Bind**, then the button or key itself. The line beside the button reads **not bound** until it captures one.



3 • Tick it onto a control. **Edit** on any binding opens this dialog – here the **Helmet Visor** control, bound to button 26. Rebind it with **Bind**, and tick any modifiers it should require in the panel below: the control then fires only when its own button *and* every ticked modifier are held. The panel says **no modifiers defined yet** until you have made one on the Modifiers tab.

14 Settings, Start-up & Updates

► Start with Windows

Tick ☐ **Start with Windows** to have Modern F-15E launch automatically when you sign in (it starts minimized to the tray). Untick to remove it from start-up. No admin rights are needed to turn this on or off.

► Settings...

opens your settings file (`settings.json`, under `%APPDATA%\DcsWebDataLink\`) selected in Explorer. Most options are managed for you through the menu and the Controls dialog; this is here for manual edits (for example, correcting a DCS folder path). Changes take effect on the next launch.

► Updates

Modern F-15E keeps itself up to date automatically:

- On launch it quietly checks for a newer release and **downloads it in the background**. When the download is ready, a small window appears: *"A new version is ready to install."* Click to apply it right away, or to keep flying.
- If you choose (or close the window), the update **applies automatically the next time you start the app** — nothing else to do.
- Either way, once you're on the new version a brief tray tip confirms *"Updated to version x.xx.x."*
- checks on demand. If you're current it says *"You are currently up to date."*

NOTE • UPDATING THE IN-COCKPIT FILES

When the app updates, its DCS-side files may also need refreshing. If DCS is open at that moment the files are locked, and the app tells you to close DCS and relaunch (or use **Verify files**). The "DCS files" status line reflects this.

15 Troubleshooting & FAQ

The SIT page is enabled but I don't see the overlay in the cockpit.

Confirm the SIT page is the *displayed* format on that MFD — it shows only there. Then check the tray `DCS files: ...` line: if it says *needs repair* or *update pending* — *close DCS*, close DCS, click **Verify files**, and relaunch DCS.

The MFD just shows a solid green screen.

A freshly-SOI'd TSD can flash solid green for a moment before the SIT page appears over it. Confirm the jet is powered (engines running) and the tray shows `DCS: Connected`, and give it a second to lock on. If it stays solid green, the overlay isn't running — close DCS, click **Verify files** from the tray menu, and relaunch.

I use OptiScaler (or another upscaler / DLSS tool) and the SIT shows a green box.

Both the mod and OptiScaler want the same file — `dxgi.dll` in your DCS `bin` folder — and only one of them can have it. If OptiScaler takes it, the mod loses the rendering runtime it needs and the SIT can't paint; if the mod takes it, your upscaler stops working. Every mod update reinstalls the file, which is why the problem comes back.

The fix: OptiScaler can install itself under a different name. In its own installer or config, choose `winmm`, `dbghelp` or `wininet` instead of `dxgi`. Both then run together and neither needs touching again. This is OptiScaler's own supported option, not a workaround on our side.

"DCS files: update pending — close DCS" won't clear.

The overlay file is locked while DCS runs. Fully close DCS, then click **Verify files** (or just relaunch the app with DCS closed).

I enabled/disabled the SA page and got a "Close DCS first" warning.

Enabling and disabling both write into the DCS install folder, which requires DCS to be closed. Close DCS and toggle again.

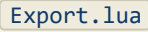
The cursor doesn't move when I slew.

If `AUTO` is on, the cursor follows the A/A radar and only appears when the radar is SOI — make the A/A radar your sensor of interest, or press `AUTO` off for manual mode. In manual mode, open `Controls...` and make sure a Device and the correct Axis X/Y are selected (watch the live bars).

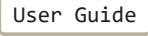
Up/down barely moves the cursor; I have to add left/right.

Auto-detect swapped your axes. In `Controls...`, move only your slew, note which bars light up, and set Axis X/Y to match (toggle Invert Y if push-up moves the dot down).

I turned off — is the mod fully off?

Yes.  Unticking  now **fully deactivates** the DCS-side files — it removes the overlay hook and comments the mod's line out of your  — so DCS runs completely stock. Re-tick it (with DCS closed) to restore everything.

Where do I get this document again?

Tray menu → . If the PDF is missing for any reason, the app points you to the GitHub releases page.

Modern F-15E

User Guide · Version 1.49.4

For the F-15E Strike Eagle situational-awareness MFD overlay in DCS World.

Menu labels, dialog fields, and behaviors describe Modern F-15E v1.49.4.